



38. The long-standing complaint by the USPS and its unions can be addressed by _____.	38. USPS 及其工会长久以来的不满可能通过 _____ 得到解决。
[A] removing its burden of retiree health care	[A] 移除其退休人员医保开支负担
[B] making more investment in new vehicles	[B] 增加新运输工具的资金投入
[C] adopting a new rate-increase mechanism	[C] 采用新的邮资费率增长机制
[D] attracting more first-class mail users	[D] 吸引更多普通邮件用户

[精准定位] 第三段②③句指出新法规提出的缓解 USPS 财政困难的两种方式：每封信邮资费率上涨 1 美分；将退休人员转入联邦医疗保险。④句指出，后一举措将大幅抵消预付退休人员医保造成的财政负担，化解 USPS 及其工会长久以来的抱怨。可见 [A] 正确。

[命题解密] 正确项 [A] removing its burden of retiree health care 同义改写第三段③句 shifting postal retirees into Medicare(④句 the latter step 所指)。

[B] 源自②句立法举措的积极意义“所节省资金可用于负担新运输工具”，但这与 USPS 及其工会的抱怨消解无因果关联。[C] 源自③句法案的前一举措(former step)，且将“提高邮资费率”篡改为“采用新的邮资费率增长机制”。[D] 与立法举措“提高邮资费率”的可预期后果“邮件用户减少”显然矛盾。

[技巧总结] 命题人于涉及“多重指代关系、多个提及对象”的内容设置“结果—方式(可视为因果关系)题”，旨在考查考生梳理文中关系的能力。解题时应：借助逻辑关联词初步理清句内/句间逻辑，厘清“词汇替换”和“代词所指”，明确文中对应关系；识别“强加因果”或“偷换因果”的陷阱。

具体来看，先由题干关键词 long-standing complaint by the USPS and its unions 定位至第三段末句，thus 明确主句内容为原因，初步锁定 [A]。再上溯探寻 The latter step 所指即 shifting postal retirees into Medicare，可完全确定 [A] 正确。[B] 虽为文中提及内容，但与题干所问没有因果关联。[C]、[D] 不仅与题干所问没有因果关联，且违背原文事实细节。

IV ① If it clears the House, this **measure**^① would still have to get through the Senate—where someone is bound to point out that it amounts to the **bare**^②, bare minimum necessary to keep the Postal Service afloat, not comprehensive reform. ② There's no change to collective bargaining at the USPS, a major **omission**^③ considering that personnel accounts for 80 percent of the agency's costs. ③ Also missing is any discussion of **eliminating**^④ Saturday letter delivery. ④ That common-sense change enjoys wide public support and would save the USPS \$2 billion per year. ⑤ But postal special-interest groups seem to have killed it, at least in the House. ⑥ The emerging consensus around the bill is a sign that legislators are getting frightened about a politically **embarrassing**^⑥ short-term **collapse**^⑦ at the USPS. ⑦ It is not, however, a sign that they're getting serious about **transforming**^⑦ the postal system for the 21st century. [426 words]

假若提案获众议院批准，还必须在参议院获得通过——那里一定会有人指出，它仅仅是使邮政维持下去所必须的最低，最低要求，并非彻底的改革。USPS 内的集体谈判丝毫未变，鉴于员工成本占机构总成本的 80%，这是一项重大疏漏。此外，提案中丝毫未对取消周六信件投递服务进行讨论。这一讲究实际的变革享有广泛的公众支持，且每年会为 USPS 节约 20 亿美元。但是邮政特殊利益群体似乎已经将其扼杀，至少在众议院是这样。围绕此提案逐渐形成的共识表明，立法者对 USPS 短期内崩溃所带来的政治难堪感到害怕。然而，这并非表明他们开始认真对待邮政系统面向 21 世纪的转型。